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WaTech
Washington Technology Solutions

INTEGRATION SERVICES
ENTERPRISE SERVICE STANDARD

See Also:
RCW 43.105.006 WaTech Purpose
RCW 43.105.054 WaTech Governance
RCW 43.105.020 Definitions
RCW 43.105.450 State agency information technology security

1. PURPOSE

This standard establishes the statewide service capability, Integration Services, as an enterprise service under EA-02 – Establishing an Enterprise Service Policy. Integration Services provides a shared, centrally governed capability for secure, consistent, and scalable system integration and data exchange across Washington state government. It supports legacy and modern systems through file transfer, message brokering, and Application Programming Interface (API)-based connectivity under a shared delivery and governance model.

Integration Services has been designated as an enterprise service to reduce fragmented, agency-specific integration solutions and point-to-point connections. This enterprise service is intended to reduce technical debt, increase delivery speeds, reduce manual processing, eliminate duplicative development, and mitigate risk to enterprise security and operations.

A Washington state agency must not adopt, build, expand, or renew a service with similar capabilities unless it has an approved waiver (see Section 5).

2. SCOPE

IN SCOPE

Integration Services must be used to connect systems and automate data exchanges for inter-agency state business operations when:

- Data moves between agencies or external partners.
- Reusable APIs or shared integration patterns are required.

OUT OF SCOPE

- Ad-hoc, end-user file sharing or manual exchanges that do not establish an integration (e.g., email attachments or one-time manual uploads).
- One-time data extracts performed solely for reporting or analysis.
- Native product integrations when they operate within an approved system or agency boundary. This includes embedded reporting/analytics connections (such as Power BI).

3. APPLICABILITY

This standard applies to all state agencies (as defined in RCW 43.105.020) and their organizational users (including employees, contractors, partners, and vendors).

This standard does not apply to the K-20 network, institutions of higher education, the legislature, the judiciary, or local governments (as defined in RCW 43.105.020).

4. ENTERPRISE SERVICE CAPABILITIES

Integration Services encompasses the following capabilities:

1. Enterprise-managed secure file transfer and automated file exchange.
2. Enterprise message routing and brokering (e.g., enterprise service bus) for system-to-system integration across agencies and shared services.
3. Enterprise capabilities for reusable service-based interfaces (e.g., APIs) between agencies, shared services, and authorized external organizations
4. Enterprise-managed connectivity to enable secure integration between systems operating across on-premises, cloud, and hybrid environments.

5. WAIVERS AND EXEMPTIONS TO THIS STANDARD

In accordance with POL-01-02-S Technology Policy and Standard Waiver Request Standard, agencies may qualify for a waiver or exemption from compliance with this standard. Agencies may request an exemption for situations that meet one of the following criteria.

1. Systems with validated performance or latency requirements that cannot be met by Integration Services, including ultra-low latency operational workloads.
2. Legal, regulatory, or compliance requirements that cannot be supported by the existing capabilities of the enterprise service.
3. Specialized operational environments, including public safety systems, SCADA, or proprietary operational platforms requiring alternative integration approaches.
4. Existing integration platforms that support critical statewide systems and data exchanges.

6. AUTHORITY

This standard is issued under the authority of RCW 43.105.054, which grants Washington Technology Solutions authority to establish statewide technology standards and enterprise services. RCW 43.105.006 establishes Washington Technology Solutions as the centralized provider of broadly used and uniform technology services. RCW 43.105.450 requires state agencies to comply with statewide information technology security policies and standards.

REFERENCES

1. Service Catalog Page: Integration Services
2. Definition of Terms Used in WaTech Policies and Reports
3. EA-02 Establishing an Enterprise Service Policy
4. MGMT-01-01-S Technology Portfolio Foundation – Application Standard
5. POL-01-01-PR Technology Policies and Standards Waiver Procedure
6. RCW 43.105.006 WaTech Purpose
7. RCW 43.105.020 Definitions
8. RCW 43.105.054 WaTech Governance
9. RCW 43.105.450 State agency information technology security
10. SEC-02-01-S Application Security Standard
11. SEC-06 Access Control Policy
12. SEC-06-01-S Identification and Authentication Security Standard
13. SEC-08-01-S Data Classification Standard
14. SEC-08-02-S Encryption Standard
15. SEC-11-01-S Risk Assessment Standard

CONTACT INFORMATION

For questions about this policy, please email the WaTech Policy Mailbox.